The fourth phase took place from October to November 1948. During these months, Operations "Hiram" in the north and "Yoav" in the south were launched. In the north, there were forced expulsions from some places and voluntary flights from others. In the south, there was mainly expulsion. During this phase, another two hundred thousand Arabs became refugees when they fled or were ejected from their homes.

The final phase lasted throughout 1949 and even into 1950. The State of Israel expelled some of the residents of Zakaria (outside of Jerusalem), Iqrit and Bir'am (along the Lebanese border), and Majdal (Ashkelon), some within the borders of the state and some outside of them. These expulsions were defended as being due to security considerations in the context of preventing the aiding of infiltrators and future attacks from beyond the border.

I am a Jew and an Israeli patriot, and I do not profess to be objective, but when I read about the decision-making processes of the Yishuv leaders during this period, led by David Ben-Gurion, I must say that I am proud to be a Jew and an Israeli. In reading these, it is very easy to recognize that the leaders of the Yishuv, some more than others, agonized over each decision concerning the future of the Arab inhabitants of the country, not only at the general strategic level, but also when it came down to examining the case of each individual Arab village—this, though there is no dispute that the Arabs were the ones who instigated the hostilities and violence against the Jewish community immediately after the UN vote on the Partition Plan and that the Arab armies invaded Israel upon the termination of the Mandate without provocation or real cause.

The principal document of the Jewish Yishuv regarding the fate of the Arabs in the Mandate area, in between whose lines one can identify the moral dilemmas involved, is "Plan D," which was prepared in March 1948 by a group of commanders led by Yigael Yadin. Yadin was the Haganah's head of operations and throughout most of the War of Independence served as the de facto chief of staff. The plan was intended to defend the Jewish state that was to be established and the Jewish blocs outside its proposed territory from the expected invasion of the Arab armies after May 15, 1948. It was clear to the leaders of the Haganah that defeating the irregular Arab forces (the so-called "gangs") was a necessary precondition for their future capability to confront the regular Arab armies. In order to control the roads and strategic areas, the Arab towns and villages that dominated them